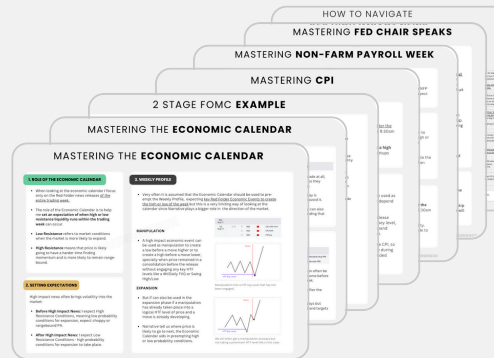


MASTERING THE ECONOMIC CALENDAR



1. MASTERING THE ECONOMIC CALENDAR
 - a. Role of the Economic Calendar
 - b. Setting Expectations
 - c. Weekly Profile
 - d. Types of Red Folder Releases
 - e. Bank Holidays
 - f. No Red Folder Days
2. NAVIGATING KEY RED FOLDER RELEASES
 - a. FOMC
 - b. CPI
 - c. NFP Friday
 - d. Fed Chair Speaks
 - e. Cheat Sheet

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MASTERING THE ECONOMIC CALENDAR

1. ROLE OF THE ECONOMIC CALENDAR

- When looking at the economic calendar I focus only on the Red Folder news releases of the entire trading week.
- The role of the Economic Calendar is to help me **set an expectation of when high or low resistance liquidity runs within the trading week** can occur.
- **Low Resistance** refers to market conditions when the market is more likely to expand.
- **High Resistance** means that price is likely going to have a harder time finding momentum and is more likely to remain range-bound.

2. SETTING EXPECTATIONS

High impact news often brings volatility into the market:

- **Before High Impact News:** I expect High Resistance Conditions, meaning low probability conditions for expansion, expect choppy or rangebound PA.
- **After High Impact News:** I expect Low Resistance Conditions - high probability conditions for expansion to take place.

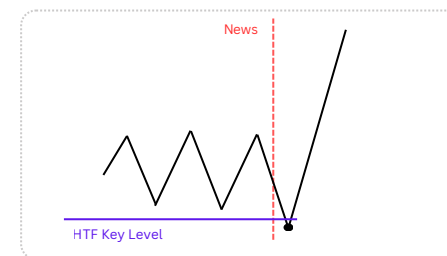
3. WEEKLY PROFILE

- Very often it is assumed that the Economic Calendar should be used to preempt the Weekly Profile, expecting key Red Folder Economic Events to create the high or low of the week but this is a very limiting way of looking at the calendar since Narrative plays a bigger role in the direction of the market.

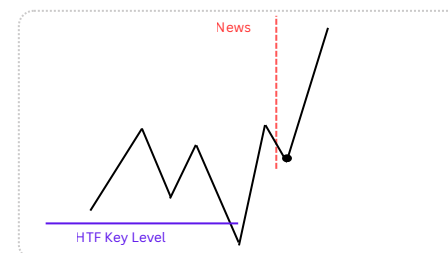
MANIPULATION

- A high impact economic event can be used as manipulation to create a low before a move higher or to create a high before a move lower, specially when price remained in a consolidation before the release without engaging any key HTF levels like a 4H/Daily FVG or Swing High/Low

Mon Aug 11					
Tue Aug 12	8:30	))	USD		Core CPI m/m
		))	USD		CPI m/m
		))	USD		CPI y/y



Manipulation into a HTF key level that has not been engaged.



We will often get a manipulation anyways but not taking a prominent HTF level like in this case.

MASTERING THE ECONOMIC CALENDAR

4. TYPES OF RED FOLDER RELEASES

- Not all high impact news are the same. Some can affect price from days before their release, some hours before.

KEY HIGH IMPACT NEWS

- Key High Impact news events like: CPI, FOMC, NFP, Fed Chairman Speaks, often result in lower probability conditions from **the day before and hours before their release.**

8:30	»	USD		Average Hourly Earnings m/m
	»	USD		Non-Farm Employment Change
8:30	»	USD		Core CPI m/m
10:00	»	USD		Fed Chair Powell Speaks
▶14:00	»	USD		Federal Funds Rate
	»	USD		FOMC Economic Projections
	»	USD		FOMC Statement
14:30	»	USD		FOMC Press Conference

- I can trade the day before and session before their release (not in the same session before release) understanding that price might remain rangebound so I take profit faster/keep targets nimble. Some traders avoid the day before altogether.
- I often wait at least 30 mins after the release before resuming trading.

MEDIUM - HIGH IMPACT NEWS

- For these type of news releases I tend to avoid taking positions at least 30mins before their release and wait for at least 5 mins before hunting for setups again. As always, the key is to wait for the market to look high probability.

Red Folder I consider Mid High Impact:

- PPI
- FOMC Meeting Minutes / wait 15mins
- Prelim GDP
- Retail Sales
- Flash PMI

8:30	»	USD		Core PPI m/m
8:30	»	USD		Prelim GDP q/q
8:30	»	USD		Core Retail Sales m/m
	»	USD		Retail Sales m/m

LOW - HIGH IMPACT NEWS

- For other high impact news I just avoid having any positions opened during the release and then wait a couple of minutes before allowing myself to get back in the market.

5. BANK HOLIDAYS

All Day USD  Bank Holiday

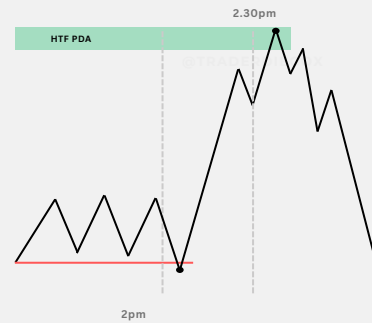
- In days with Bank Holidays I don't trade at all, they often have abbreviated hours so they can offer low probability conditions.
- The PM Session before a Bank Holiday is often slow or choppy and I tend to avoid it.
- The AM session after a bank holiday can also be slow, but I can trade it understanding that it can be a rangebound session.

6. NO RED FOLDER DAYS

Mon Sep 22				
Tue Sep 23	9:45	»	USD	 Flash Manufacturing PMI
		»	USD	 Flash Services PMI

- Days without Red Folder releases can often be a small range day, specially if they come before the first high impact news of the week.
- Price is more easily allowed to run after the first high impact news of the week.
- I can hunt for setups during these days but keeping my expectations measured and targets small.

MASTERING FOMC



▶ 14:00	)	USD	🏢	Federal Funds Rate
	)	USD	🏢	FOMC Economic Projections
	)	USD	🏢	FOMC Statement
14:30	)	USD	🏢	FOMC Press Conference

1. What to expect
2. Two Stages of Manipulation
3. Before FOMC
4. After FOMC
5. FOMC Meeting Minutes
6. Two Stage Manipulation Example

MASTERING FOMC

1. WHAT TO EXPECT

- FOMC Usually releases on Wednesday at 2:00pm and 2:30pm NY time.
- It's a 2-stage high volatility release.
- FOMC is not so much the release of a number but rather a series of speeches, so the moves in the market don't need to come right at 2pm and 2:30pm, it can take a few minutes to see volatility.

2. TWO STAGES OF MANIPULATION

- The 1st stage of manipulation comes after 2pm, the 2nd stage comes after 2:30pm.
- Meaning that we're not gonna get the usual manipulation and then distribution move.
- Instead we're likely to get a 1st manipulation aimed at quickly engineering liquidity, then a 2nd manipulation to take it out and then the distribution move in line with the prevailing narrative.

** All times are in New York Time

3. BEFORE FOMC

- **Previous Day:** This release can have an effect on price from the day before, specially the PM Session.
- **On FOMC day:** PA might start consolidating after 10am. Ideally I'm done trading the AM session before 11am if trading at all.

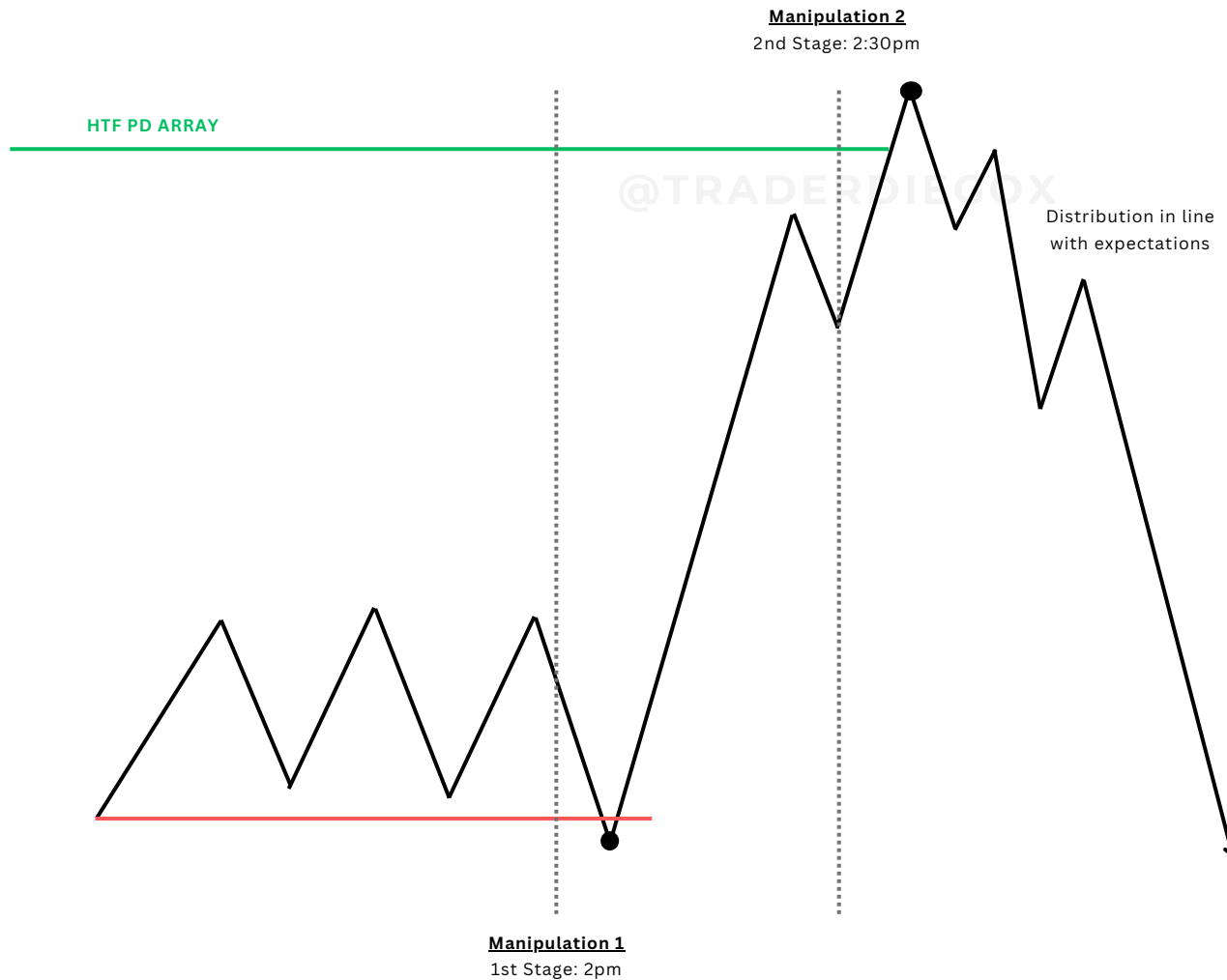
4. AFTER FOMC

- After 2:30pm, I want to **wait at least 15 to 20** mins before looking for setups.
- It's more likely that during the **Final Hour Macro** from 3 - 4pm the algorithm starts presenting more opportunities.

5. FOMC MEETING MINUTES

- This is a normal 1 stage release not to be confused with FOMC Press Conference.
- FMM usually comes at 2pm, so wait 15 to 30 mins after release before hunting for setups in the PM session.
- In the AM session same as FOMC applies.

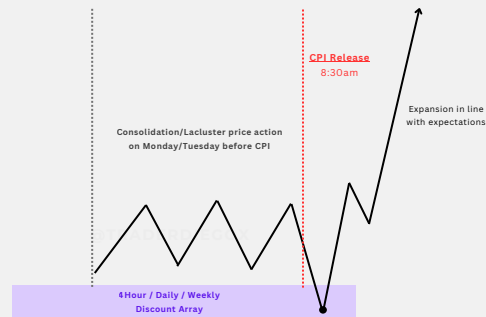
2 STAGE FOMC EXAMPLE



This is just an example of how the release can play out.

- A lot of the times, the strong moves left by the release can be used as a strong draw on liquidity for price.
- Other times, the release won't have a big impact in the market and we just have to wait a few mins until it's safe to go back in the market.
- But always keep in mind to trade in line with the prevailing narrative.

MASTERING **CPI**



8:30 » USD 🇺🇸 Core CPI m/m

1. What to expect
2. Before CPI
3. After CPI
4. Adding Narrative

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MASTERING CPI

1. WHAT TO EXPECT

- CPI **usually comes at 8:30am** on a Wednesday but it can be scheduled for other days, like Tuesday.
- This release usually has a big impact on the market and the day before or hours before can be used as manipulation.

4. AFTER CPI

- Stand aside for at least 15 to 30 mins after the release. Often I will wait 1 hour until the 9:30am CME Open.
- **The key is to WAIT until the market looks high probability again**, not just hunting for setups that might not be there.

3. BEFORE CPI

The Day Before CPI:

- We can have a slow session. If you trade it demand pristine price action.
- The AM session or PM session before CPI might present choppy or Seek and Destroy conditions.

On CPI Day

- On CPI day, ideally I don't want to look for premarket setups.

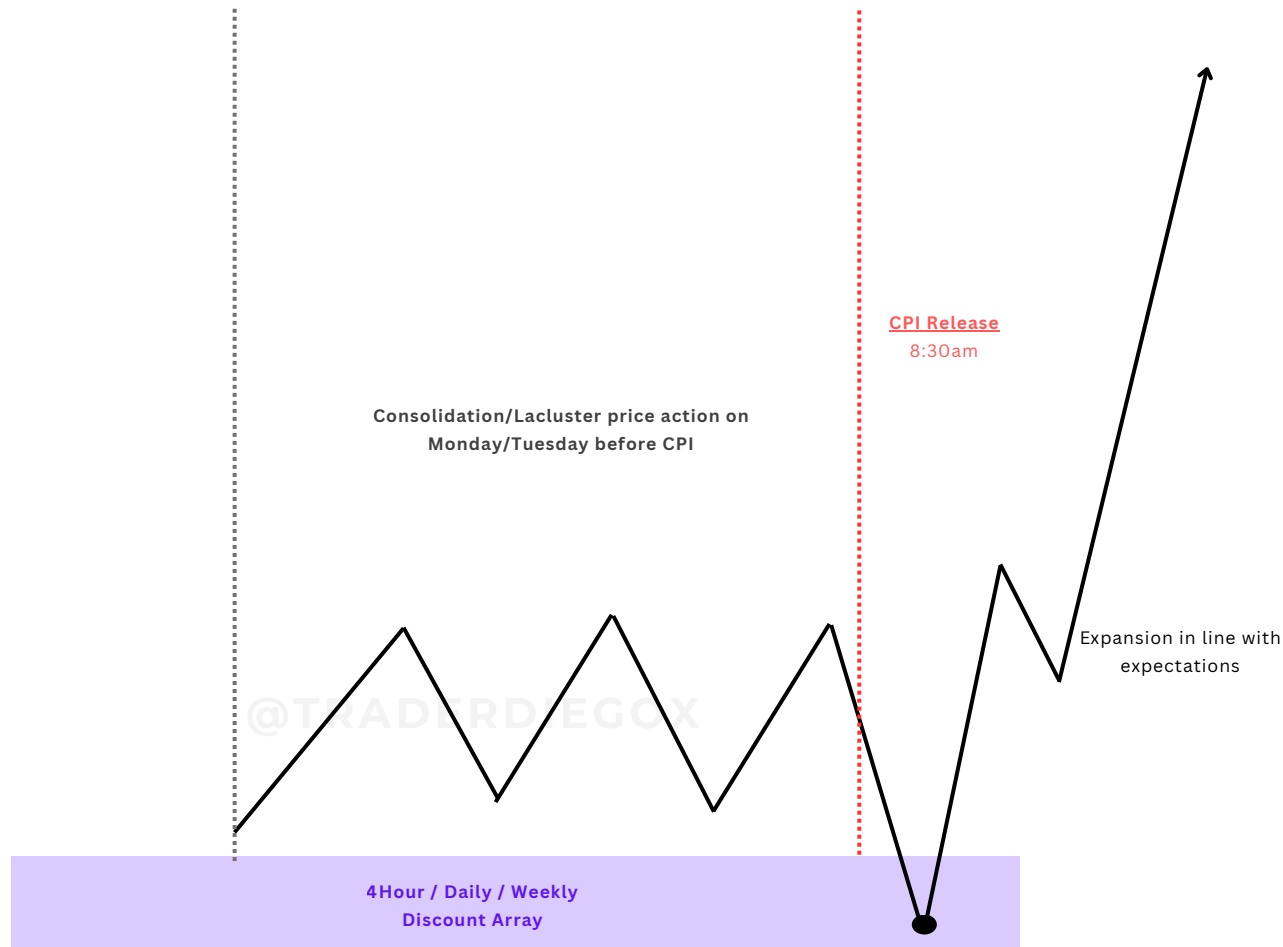
4. ADDING NARRATIVE

Key high probability releases like CPI can be used as manipulation or as expansion, what does it depend on?

- It depends on Narrative. If before the release price manipulates into a 4hour or Daily key level, then the release is likely to be use to expand price in line with the prevailing narrative.
- Very often price will consolidated before CPI, so I'd rather see manipulation to take place during the release before reversing in the intended direction.

** All times are in New York Time

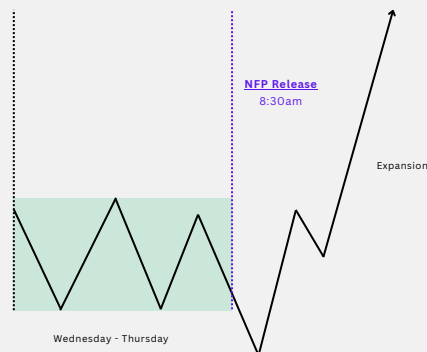
CPI EXAMPLE



CPI RELEASE:

- This is just one scenario that can play out if we get a consolidation before CPI.
 - We will see very choppy price action or Seek and Destroy conditions the day before.
 - Then on CPI we can get a manipulation move into a High Timeframe PD Array before expansion takes place.
- Keep in mind that expansion can be either continuation of the current trend or reversal after moving into a HTF key level.

MASTERING NFP WEEK



8:30	»	USD	🇺🇸	Average Hourly Earnings m/m
	»	USD	🇺🇸	Non-Farm Employment Change

1. What to expect
2. Best Days To Trade
3. NFP Week with Holidays
4. FOMC Before NFP
5. NFP Friday
6. Trading It

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MASTERING NON-FARM PAYROLL WEEK

1. WHAT TO EXPECT

- NFP usually comes the **first Friday of the month at 8:30am**
- During Non-Farm Payrolls Week the precision will be reduced but the algorithm will still be at work.

2. BEST DAYS TO TRADE

Monday to Wednesday

- These are the safest days to trade during the week. Ideally Wednesday until the AM session.

Thursday

- This will be the lowest probability day, you can avoid it or focus on only the most obvious setups.

Friday

- It's best at least 30 mins to 1 hour after the release.

3. NFP WEEK WITH HOLIDAYS

- If on Monday, Tuesday or Wednesday we have a holiday, then we want to refrain from trading on Monday, but Thursday and Friday after NFP will usually give good opportunities.

** All times are in New York Time

4. FOMC BEFORE NFP

- When we get FOMC on Wednesday before NFP and it's a very volatile release, we don't expect NFP to have much of an impact.

5. NFP FRIDAY

- On Friday the market will sometimes move to take Wednesday's and Thursday's range high or low. (sometimes just a 1H buy/sell side Liquidity)
- In most cases the 8:30am Release will create the manipulation move to take liquidity and then move the other way aggressively.

6. TRADING IT

- **We can trade Friday at least 30 mins after the release**, meaning after 9am, ideally after 9:30am CME Open.
- Focus on the market looking high probability. Don't just hunt for setups, wait for the trade to look obvious.

MASTERING **FED CHAIR SPEAKS**



Fed Chair Powell Speaks

1. What to expect
2. Manual Intervention
3. Before Fed Chair Speaks
4. After Fed Chair Speaks

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MASTERING FED CHAIR SPEAKS

1. WHAT TO EXPECT

- Fed Chairman Speaks is a high-impact economic event that often comes in the NY AM Session around 10am but it can also come in the PM session.
- While not as impactful as CPI, FOMC or NFP, it can have an impact on the market on the Day or hours before its release.
- I treat **Fed Chair Speaks** and **Fed Chair Testifies** in the same way.

2. MANUAL INTERVENTION

- Fed Chair Speaks often means there's going to be manual intervention, you don't know where they want to take price.
- Any PD Array can be disrespected so don't attempt to know where the market is going to go.

2. BEFORE FED CHAIR SPEAKS

The Day Before:

- The day before Fed Chair Speaks is usually a small range day, we're not expecting a big move. I can trade it but understanding that price might not expand as much so I will focus on low hanging fruit targets.

On Fed Chair Speaks Day:

- When Fed Chair Speaks comes in the AM session the market will usually provide a premarket setup. We can hunt for entries after 7am but stop looking for them shortly after 8:30am NY.
- I will often refrain from trading until after the release in the AM session.
- If it releases in the PM session I can trade the AM session focusing on pristine PA.

5. AFTER FED CHAIR SPEAKS

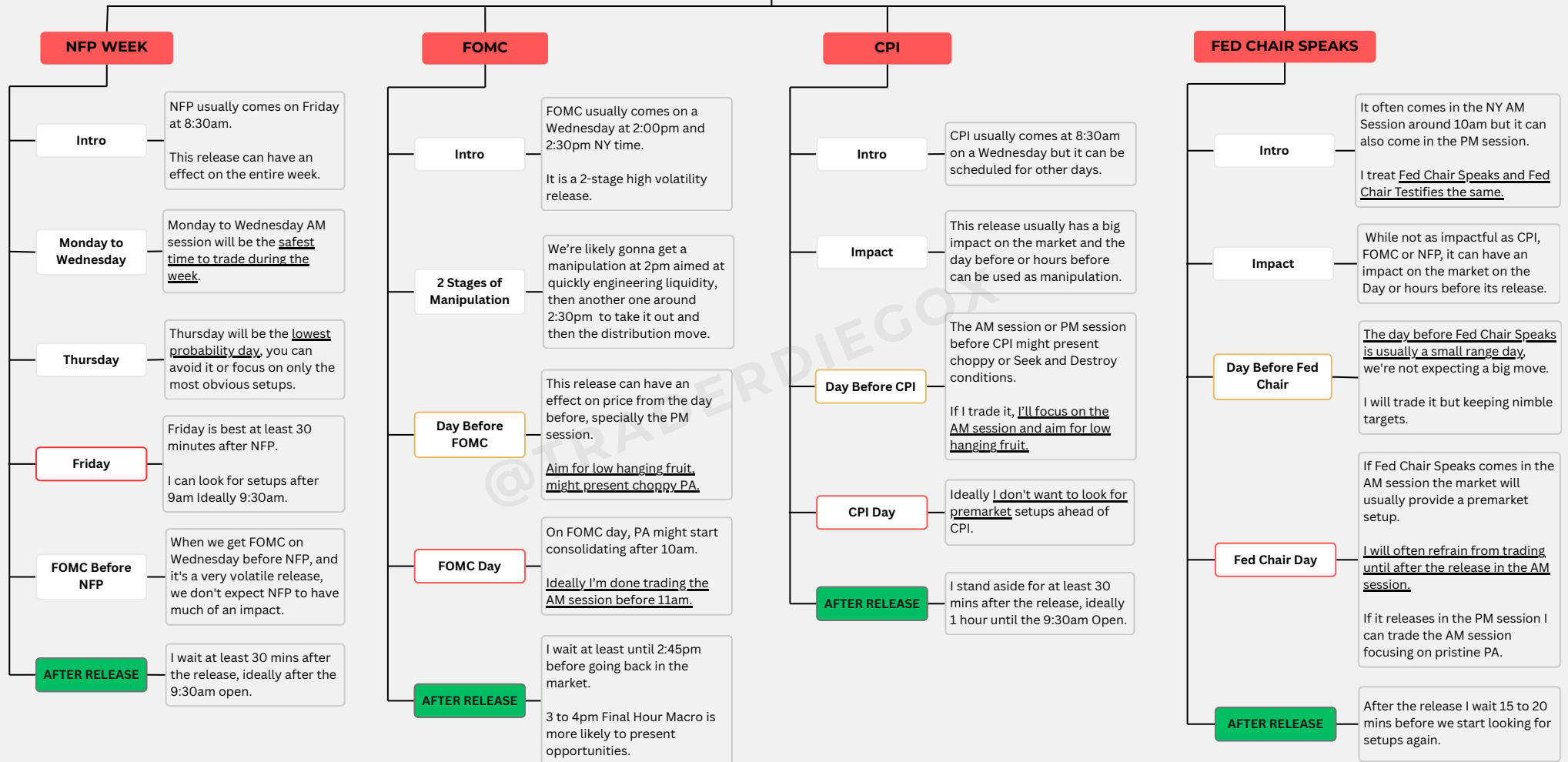
- After the release we wait 15 to 20 mins before we start looking for setups again.
- If this release comes in the AM session, we can skip it and wait for the PM session after 1:30pm. We will usually get the best setup after this time.

** All times are in New York Time

HOW TO NAVIGATE KEY HIGH IMPACT NEWS

** All times are in New York Time

KEY HIGH IMPACT NEWS



NOTES:

- Do not confuse FOMC Press Conference with FOMC Meeting Minutes, FOMC MM is a one stage release that usually comes at 2pm on a Wednesday. You can treat it just like FOMC. Wait 15 to 30 mins to start hunting for setups.
- I never leave any positions opened DURING any of these releases since they can move price several points in a matter of seconds. Being on the wrong side of these releases can cause huge losses.